KAN VATAN

BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

a pilot for an original series

written by

Max Coyne-Green

October 19, 2026

Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving and joining over time.

These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER: **HATAY PROVINCE - 2013**

CRUNCH of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on the rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)
Baba. It's--

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
--me.

His fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold).**

DAVUT
Someone was chasing me.

She pats her father's back: *sure, Baba.* Then gently takes Davut's arm, leads him up the hill...

...his bare feet trail RED BLOOD in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAWN

RED MUD under hiking boots 30km south.

A BACKPACKER (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

Bends to pick wild yarrow, revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck. Wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his pants, grabs his backpack...and walks down the mountain.

SUPER: **YAYLADAĞI CROSSING, TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER**

A SHRIEK pierces the sky. He stops. Turns toward the sound.

A JACKAL

bleeds in the forest. On its side.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow.

The jackal SNAPS at him. But drops its head, exhausted.

He touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes relax. A moment of peace. Then he finds the wound. A bullet hole.

Shit.

A BULLET whizzes above them. The backpacker drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye. They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT through the trees.

The backpacker jumps to his feet. Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he TRIPS over a root and SMACKS his skull on a tree. Vision blurs. When he looks up--

RIFLES point down.

CUT TO:

TWO HUNTERS

drag the jackal through the trees...and the backpacker. Mouth and hands bound with rope.

Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a FIRE-PIT. BLACK SMOKE rises into the sky.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

BLACK SMOKE on a monitor. A DRONE PILOT watches the live footage. Flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:

Hunters dragging a jackal...and a backpacker.

DRONE PILOT
Commander?

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit. He feels heat on his back. Flames lick at his bound wrists.

One hunter digs through his bag. Finds a compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A PHRASEBOOK - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT
Looks like a hippie got lost on the wrong side of the mountain.

COMMANDER
(sigh, sipping tea)
May God protect him.

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT
Wait.

On the monitor: The backpacker is standing. Ropes at his feet. The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER
Pull back!

WIDER SHOT

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving. Fire burning. No sign of the backpacker.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The backpacker sprints down the mountain. As he turns back to look at the drone, he SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree. But he keeps running into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

ACT I

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Boots CRUNCH dead leaves. Sezen walks into the grove, where:

MUSA (15, skinny as a cypress) inspects fissures in the bark.

SEZEN
Günaydın.

He looks up. What? She points to the rising sun.

SEZEN
Morning.

MUSA
(nod)
Sabah.

She nods back. They're learning. She bends next to him, sees he’s looking at the black spots on the leaves.

She takes one in her hands - it crumbles immediately.

MUSA
Mayyit. Dead.

Musa switches back to *Arabic (italic).*

MUSA (CONT'D)
They need water.

HOSES

unroll from an equipment shed.

Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots.

She returns to the shed. Turns the valve. Water flows.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER THAT MORNING

WATER FLOWS as Sezen fills a glass. Grabs a big fat fig.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN
Drink.

She splits the fig, hands him a half. He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit, but--

BACK DOOR swings open. Davut emerges. Dressed for work. He inhales. Finds his way to the nearest trunk. Touches it.

DAVUT
The sun is kind today.

He looks at the shining sun, as Sezen approaches. Davut brushes her cheek. Gentle. Present.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
Your mother always said to appreciate it before it goes away.

Then something shifts in his face. He walks into the grove.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
I'm late.

SEZEN
(chasing after)
Baba. The doctor is coming today. He said to rest until he sees you.

DAVUT
There is work to be done.

SEZEN
Musa and I are handling it.

Davut stops. Turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT
I don't like his old eyes.

SEZEN
We need his help.

DAVUT
One man is enough for the summer. Help comes for harvest. That's how it's worked for seven generations.

SEZEN
We won't make it to the harvest without more help.
(beat)
The trees are sick.

DAVUT
What do you know?
(marching off again)
You're barely <u>twelve years old</u>.

Davut disappears into the grove...

...leaving Sezen speechless.

With sympathy, Musa offers his half of the fig.

DAVUT (O.S.)
(from the grove)
Tell your brother I need him.

Sezen sighs.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
I'm at work.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data. Talking to Sezen. Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

SEZEN (PHONE)
It's 11pm there.

KAAN
Midnight. But Peter's on a warpath.
He's about to fire my new analyst.

Kaan peeks into an office, boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear.

KAAN (PHONE)(CONT'D)
Kid barely made it a week.

She makes a sarcastic face. He somehow knows.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. This is serious.

SEZEN
***This* is serious. There's something**
wrong with our trees.

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly. She speaks in English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
And Baba won't listen to me. He thinks I'm 12 years old.

She drags a garbage bag outside.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen walks outside into gusting wind. Rattling the leaves.

KAAN (PHONE)
He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN
No, Kaan, I mean--

But she hears him talking to someone else.

SEZEN
Kaan!

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan quickly finishes his conversation with a colleague and returns to the call with Sezen.

KAAN
Sorry. Just tell me what you need.

SEZEN (PHONE)
HELP!

This is loud. He sneaks to the window.

KAAN
Relax. I can pay someone--

SEZEN (PHONE)
Money doesn't solve everything.

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN
It has a pretty high hit rate.

No response. Kaan hears the wind whipping through his family's trees. It settles him. He switches back to Turkish:

KAAN
Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He already has one of those.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - SAME

Sezen shoves the garbage bag into a can.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan holds the phone for a beat.

Then sees Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Kaan finds Jimmy’s shoes under the stall door.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I’m a fucking idiot.

Kaan leans on a sink. Impatient. Forces a Big Brother tone.

KAAN
You’re not a *fucking idiot*. Just tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)
That my pitch would make good fertilizer.

KAAN
(head snapping to door)
What?

STALL

Jimmy’s on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

JIMMY
Because it’s dogshit.

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

KAAN
No. Jimmy. I mean: why are you pitching Peter?

JIMMY
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell him about the chicken--

KAAN
Chicken? God damnit, dude.

BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I shut down chicken for a reason. Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I don't understand. It's a real opportunity. This bird flu is crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN
Exactly, "*the CDC says*". You're not the only one who can read. And this isn't fucking Fidelity.
(settling himself)
Listen. I know you're new to this. But we make money by betting *against* consensus. We have to know what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous. Whispers:

JIMMY
And that's like...okay?

KAAN
What are you saying?

JIMMY
Nothing--

KAAN
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Mutters:

KAAN (CONT'D)
Fucking idiot.

HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Kaan marches out, right into Peter - who checks his watch.

PETER
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are you eating our fiber snacks?

PETER (CONT'D)
(off Kaan's slow nod)
Good. Because things are getting clogged up around here. I promised the partners I'd clear some space.

KAAN
Jimmy has potential--

PETER
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER
Find me something good, Kaan. Before I find someone better.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

The backpacker races down the mountain. Hides in a group of pine trees. Catches breath. Listens. Doesn't hear anything. Grabs a cell phone from his bag.

UNCLIPS his belt buckle. Pulls out a hidden SIM CARD. Slots it in the phone. SCREEN LIGHTS UP. He dials...

This is ABE. But for now, he's known as:

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote. You're late.

ABE
I was making friends.

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
Civilians I think. Just some hunters by the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
But there were other eyes.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)
Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (AKA SNAPPER, height: 4’11”) watch tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)
The drone belongs to border control. They’ve already alerted Turkish intelligence.

EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - SAME

A government-issued sedan drives to the border station.

MARCY (V.O.)(CONT’D)
MIT Inspector Mehmet Demir is on his way now.

EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - SAME

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge, revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

The badge reads: MIT - Counterterrorism.

ABE (V.O.)
You’re familiar?

MARCY (V.O.)
Not yet.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Just find Brando. And remember: this isn’t Anbar. If you get taken, we can’t ask for you back.

ABE (PHONE)
(sigh)
I know.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - SAME

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway.

HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

WILL (40, codename: BRANDO) sings with AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK on the radio. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest. He pulls over to the side of the road.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE
Brando?

WILL
Coyote.
(smirking)
I heard you make quite an entrance.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER
He doesn't look like a terrorist.

DEMIR
And what does a terrorist look like to you, Commander?

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
It's been three months since Reyhanlı and we have exactly zero suspects. We need to be taking all leads extremely seriously.

COMMANDER
(intimidated but offended)
Of course, Inspector. We <u>are</u> taking this extremely seriously.

He opens the door to the:

SURVEILLANCE ROOM

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering. Watching <u>DRONE FOOTAGE</u> of Abe taking down the Hunters at the border.

DRONE PILOT
Wait. This is my favorite part!

On the monitor, Demir sees: Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLDIER
Play it again!

COMMANDER
That's enough!

DEMIR
Do it.

Pilot looks at the Commander, who nods. He plays the footage. Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions. Notices the scar on Abe's neck.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

The scar on Abe's neck...below ABE'S NERVOUS FACE.

He clutches the door handle as Will drives. Fast. 160 km/h.

WILL
Unclench your asshole. It's only 48 hours. And I only get paid if I send you back alive.

EXPLOSION in the distance. Abe swings to look.

WILL
Just breathe. In for four. Hold for four. Out for four. Do it.

Abe tries it. *In, hold, out, hold.* His heart rate slows down.

Will pulls the truck to the side of the road. Abe stiffens.

WILL
Coyote. What'd I just tell you?

RIFLES ON THE WINDOWS

WILL (CONT'D)
Breathe.

Armed men surround the truck. Without looking, Will puts down the window. Smiles at them. *Salam Alaykum.*

30 SECONDS LATER

The aid truck drives away from the checkpoint.

WILL
I feed people around here, Coyote. And everyone likes the breadman.

ABE
Are they regime?

Will shrugs. *Does it matter?*

ABE (CONT'D)
I'm just trying to keep track of who the good guys and bad guys are.

WILL
Look around, Coyote.

They pass under a bridge where DEAD BODIES HANG.

WILL (CONT'D)
The good guys are all dead.

Blood drips onto the truck.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

EXPLOSIONS on the news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR
Can you turn that down?

Davut doesn't hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut's leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
Davut Bey. You need rest. At least until we know more.

Davut pushes the Doctor's hand aside. Rises unevenly. Ambles to the window. The Doctor knows better than to try to help.

DAVUT
My father died right there. On his ladder. His head in the branches. It was a fine harvest that year.

KITCHEN - SAME

Sezen chops vegetables. Can overhear from the other room.

DOCTOR (O.S.)
I don't like what you're suggesting.

DAVUT (O.S.)
These creatures are alive. They thrive and suffer based on what we provide. And we thrive and suffer based on what they return.

DOCTOR (O.S.)
You are not the only one in this family, Davut Bey.

Sezen stops chopping.

DOCTOR (O.S.)(CONT'D)
Let Sezen handle the grove until harvest. She's more capable than you assume.

She doesn't hear the response. It's a long silence. Then the Doctor steps out, to the front door. He looks back at her, opens his mouth, closes it. Leaves.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - DUSK

LEYLA (22) chops vegetables. Dumps them in the lamb stew. Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency. As she reaches for spices on a high shelf, we see a thick scar wrapped around her ankle. Like a chain.

When a TRUCK RUMBLES to the house, she smooths her dress.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - SAME

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND. RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

Abe follows Will inside. There are tile floors, high ceilings, a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL
No "one". Just "half hour".

Will grabs a bottle, nods for Abe to follow him outside. Leyla studies Abe as he passes.

EXT. WILL’S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in sunset. Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

WILL
I’m helping with her English. She says she wants to move to America.

ABE
Where’s her family?

WILL
Kid brother’s in Turkey. Rest are prolly dead. If they’re lucky.

Abe follows Will’s eyes back to the kitchen window, where Leyla’s watching. She quickly turns away.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on his belt. Then nods to the house. *They should go inside.*

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - NIGHT

Sezen’s washing her father’s clothes when she hears HOWLING.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen steps outside. There’s blue in the sky, but the grove is dark. She hears the HOWLING again.

Musa scrambles out of a small tent. Alert. Scared.

SEZEN
It’s that jackal. Go to the house.

He wavers. She touches his shoulder. Enunciates in English.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Relax. He’s asleep.

EQUIPMENT SHED

Sezen opens a wooden chest. Pulls out an ancient REVOLVER.

IN THE GROVE

She moves deeper into the trees, gripping the revolver.

After a moment, she hears RUSTLING in the trees.

COCKS the gun as--

A YOUNG MAN named ROB emerges from behind a tree. Hands up. He's wearing a safari hat with flaps on the back. Shaking.

SOIL SAMPLE TUBES scatter at his feet.

ROB
Lütfen! Don't shoot. I don't know how to say that in Turkish yet--

SEZEN
What the fuck are you doing here?

ROB
Thank god you speak English--

SEZEN
(gripping gun tighter)
Answer the question.

ROB
Um um I'm a PhD student doing research for an American ag-tech company. I was collecting samples and I guess I got turned around. Look. I have a card in my bag--

Rob reaches down. But Sezen holds the gun up. He freezes.

ROB (CONT'D)
I swear. I'm just trying to help save your trees.

SEZEN
Save them from what?

He looks at her confused. *She doesn't know?*

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
It's a blight.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - NIGHT

Sezen digs through the trash. Phone pinched to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Rob says it's all over Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)
But who even is this guy?

SEZEN
The researcher. I just told you. You're not even listening.

KAAN (PHONE)
Of course I'm listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan's not really listening. He's researching chicken prices.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I'm just saying it's weird. Going around to every grove like he's selling snake oil?

SEZEN (PHONE)
He said the company has been reaching out for months. They've been sending letters to Baba.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - SAME

Sezen pulls envelopes from the trash. Unopened. Addressed to DAVUT YILMAZ. TERRASOURCE logo.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Here it is. Terrasource. Do you know them?
(getting nothing)
Kaan. Listen to me.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan is definitely listening now. On monitors: Terrasource stock. Research on olive trees and diseases.

KAAN
Sorry. Yeah. I know them. What are they doing in Hatay?

SEZEN (PHONE)
They have some kind of cure. Rob said it could save millions of trees, starting with ours.

KAAN
And it actually works?

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

SEZEN (PHONE)
We have to try. And they're willing to provide the rootstock and do the grafting themselves.

KAAN
What. No.

He knows Sezen will not like this tone. But she doesn't respond. He carefully considers his next move.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Sezen. These companies are pirates. No one gives anything for free.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You gave up your vote when you left, Kaan.

KAAN
But I can still be helpful. Please. Let me do some homework. And then we can look over the offer together. As a family.

Silence. Kaan grinds his teeth anxiously.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Sezen?

SEZEN (PHONE)
Whatever you say, brother.

Call ends. Kaan thinks. Looks at Peter's office. Then throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN
What do you know about olive trees?

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Sezen returns inside with several letters from TERRASOURCE. Waiting at the table, Davut with the contract Rob left behind. He seems unusually lucid.

SEZEN
That came today.
(holding up letters)
Why wouldn't you tell me they've been writing?

DAVUT
It doesn't concern you.

SEZEN
Doesn’t concern me? This is mine as much as it is yours.

DAVUT
That’s why I fight to protect it. This is all I leave you. And I will not have it poisoned by foreigners and charlatans--

SEZEN
They’re scientists, Baba. They know what they’re doing--

DAVUT
But you do not!

Davut gets to his feet. Slides the contract to the floor.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
And this conversation is over. Put it in the garbage where it belongs.
(ambling out)
Then tell Sezen to run me a bath.

BATHTUB - LATER

Sezen helps her father into the bath. Runs a cloth over him. Lifts his foot out of the water. The sole is cut open from the hillside. She cleans the wound. He winces. Lets her. The water turns pink.

When he's finished, she wraps him in a towel.

DAVUT’S BEDROOM - AFTER THAT

Sezen puts him to bed. On her way out:

DAVUT
Sezen. We have a responsibility to make hard choices for our family. Even when we disagree.

Sezen turns out the lights. Closes the door.

KITCHEN

Sezen picks up the contract off the ground. Looks at it for a while.

Then signs the name DAVUT YILMAZ.

ACT II

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Leyla cleans up the dinner plates. The house is silent.

She walks by Will's room, then the guest room, to ensure Will and Abe are both asleep.

LEYLA'S ROOM

LIGHTS ON as Leyla sits at her small desk. Pulls an English textbook. Flips the pages until she finds:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings.

And a map. Their location in Syria circled. With a line that goes across the border...to Hatay Province.

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
It's a trail of death.

INT. HEDGE FUND - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay Province.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I tracked social media complaints about dying trees and matched them to satellite imaging. It's coming from the border.

Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

KAAN
And Terrasource?

JIMMY
Terrasource has launched a line of disease-resistant cultivars for the Spanish and Greek markets. No public announcements about Turkey.

Jimmy smirks.

KAAN
So why are you smiling?

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo. "Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

JIMMY
This is the same team that did their phase one testing in Greece. Can you see where they are?

Kaan scans the photo. Behind the group, there's a road sign with distance markers for GAZIANTEP and ADANA.

Then he looks back at the group. The phases. Then the caption with the names, including: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE.

KAAN
I see it.
(beat)
Compile the research. We take this to Peter tonight.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - MORNING

Sezen watches SUNRISE through a crack in the shades. On the side of the property, a car pulls into the driveway.

Her father turns over in bed. She closes the shades. Then unplugs his alarm clock. Kisses him on the head.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - MORNING

LIGHT from Demir's cell phone flashes. The name "ELIF".

It's early. But Demir hasn't slept. He's studying evidence of the Reyhanlı car bombings pinned to his wall. Surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

A FEW MINUTES LATER

Demir speaks with his daughter, ELIF.

ELIF (PHONE)
But it's on Saturday. You promised.

DEMIR
I said I would do my best.

ELIF (PHONE)
Well do better, Baba. This is my graduation.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)
And this is my job. Please don't make it harder than it needs to be.

INT. DEMIR'S OFFICE - SAME

Call ends. Demir sighs, puts down the phone. Pins a photo on his wall. Abe's face - from the drone footage.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe looks out the truck window. To the ocean. Will's truck is finally arriving at the PORT. Cranes GROAN overhead. Russian military vehicles everywhere.

WILL
Stay in the truck.

A FERRY docks ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck.

EXT. LATAKIA PORT - A LITTLE LATER

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

MARCY (PHONE)
Brando's behaving himself?

RUSSIAN SOLDIERS move crates from ferry to Will's aid truck. Food supplies on top. Will supervises. Joking with a Russian Officer. Beneath the food: STEEL GLIMMERS in the sunlight.

ABE
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)
I trust his incentives. But he's not one of ours.

ABE
Neither am I.
(off her silence)
Just explain how I get out of here tomorrow. Will MIT be looking for me at the border?

MARCY (PHONE)
We'll send you the other way.

ABE
What. No. I'm not going back there--

MARCY (PHONE)
We don't have a choice. If you get picked up--

Abe opens the door, frustrated.

ABE
I know.

LOADING DOCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe gets out of the truck. Heads for a bathroom sign.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind. Abe SPINS and body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG RUSSIAN SOLDIER. Barely twenty. Confused.

WILL (O.S.)
Easy.

Will appears. Hand on Abe's shoulder. Smiles at the soldier.

BACK IN THE TRUCK - A MINUTE LATER

Will slams the door from inside.

WILL
I said stay in the truck.

ABE
I have to piss.

WILL
And I have to keep you alive.

SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A RUSSIAN SOLDIER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewinds to Abe's near-fight.

He pauses on Abe's face. Picks up a phone.

INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Peter does pull-ups. Kaan and Jimmy in chairs, pitching.

PETER
Does this look like a charity?

KAAN
It’s a lucrative opportunity. The disease is wrecking acres of profitable land the size of small countries, as we speak. And nobody else with Terrasource’s capabilities is even present in the region. Whatever they have, they’re years ahead of the competition.

Peter hops off the bar. Flops behind his desk.

KAAN (CONT'D)
There are sixty million olive trees in Hatay province alone. And the blight creates concentrated demand. If we get the timing right with short-dated calls before the panic starts, a bump is a windfall.

PETER
You sound remarkably certain.

KAAN
My family’s seen it themselves.

PETER
Fuck your family, Kaan. I’m talking about Terrasource. How do you know they have a market-ready solution?

Kaan considers his response. Peter assesses him. Then:

PETER
Jimmy. Get us coffee.

JIMMY
I thought you didn’t drink caff--

Peter glares at him. He scurries out. Kaan opens his mouth--

PETER (CONT'D)
I don’t want to know. Just tell me if it’s real or not.

Kaan nods. It’s real.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. We’ll execute tomorrow.

Kaan flinches. *Tomorrow?*

PETER (CONT'D)
Is that a problem?

Kaan quickly shakes his head.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. Because if you fuck me, I will burn your life to the ground.

Kaan quickly nods. Peter smiles.

PETER (CONT'D)
Let’s save some fucking trees.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen walks through the trees. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN
I’m busy.

KAAN (PHONE)
I just wanted to let you know I looked into Terrasource. And I’m impressed. But we need to be careful. We can’t be test rabbits.

SEZEN
We’re running out of time.

KAAN (PHONE)
I know that. I do. But these R&D contracts are complicated. One bad clause and they own everything that grows on our soil. Forever.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan peeks into Peter’s office.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Listen. I can come home next month. We'll look over everything.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You’re coming home?

KAAN
Isn’t that what you want?

SEZEN (PHONE)
I’m handling things on my own.

KAAN
But you don’t have to.
(beat)
You already do too much.

Silence. Kaan bites his lip. Waiting. Getting nothing.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Just don’t let Baba sign anything.
We’ll do this as a family.

The waiting continues. Painfully.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales. Hangs up. Smiles, relieved.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen hangs up, thinking.

ROB (O.S.)
Everything okay?

SEZEN
You tell me.

Sezen looks up at Rob, on a ladder, inspecting the canopy. He shows her the black leaves.

ROB
These strains are what, 500 years old? A thousand? They have no natural defense against this.

Rob cuts a diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB (CONT'D)
Can you ask Musa to pass that?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN
He knows some English.

MUSA
My sister. Teach.

SEZEN
So what happens now? You just replace the top?

ROB
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees come and go. But the roots are basically immortal. We're just giving them the best of the foreign stock so they can battle the disease and keep growing.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - DAY

A barrel bomb hits a hillside. Smoke plumes. The aid truck drives away from the lush coast into the heat of the desert.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe stares at the destruction. Will drives, relaxed.

WILL
Worse than Iraq?

Abe squints at him. *How does he know about that?*

WILL
You don't think I did my homework?

Will pulls over to a CHECKPOINT.

Suddenly, the truck is surrounded by masked gunmen. GUN BARREL to glass. Will calmly puts the window down. Drops a black bag outside.

A GUNMAN peers inside.

GUNMAN
What the fuck is this?

Other gunmen gather around, inspecting the contents.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)
No Kit Kats?

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL
Bring us in and you get the rest.

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch. Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers. Chocolate on his breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead. Breathes.

Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

REBEL COMPOUND

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact. A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.

The Guard waves them through the gate.

THE TRUCK

is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food. Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate-looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby. Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL
You really can't wait?

ABE
(walking off)
I've been waiting all day.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - A FEW MINUTES LATER

FLUSH. Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles. A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

HALLWAY

where children's drawings line the walls. He peeks inside a:

CLASSROOM

and finds old educational posters. Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just left for recess. Then he notices, on the wall:

A FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script. The black flag of Jihad. His mind flashes. Jaw tightens.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens. Hears A CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor. Puts his hand on the door handle. But doesn't turn.

Then, he hears CRYING inside.

He checks behind him, then opens the door to the:

STORAGE ROOM

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against a wall. Teens, at most.

CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)
What are you doing!?

Big FIGHTER fills the doorway. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL
He's lost--

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER
I asked you--

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE
Fuck.

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT III

OVER BLACK:

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises. The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat. Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned. It's late afternoon.

SEZEN
Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?
(off silence)
I should call the doctor--

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT
I'm fine. I have work to do--

SEZEN
I did everything. I swear.
(pressing him down)
I know you won't believe me.

He looks in her eyes. Then shakes off the dream.

DAVUT
I know I am...like vinegar. It is hard being trapped inside my mind.
(pained breath)
All I see is death.

SEZEN
I know, Baba.

DAVUT
I hope you don't.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY

Abe is bound and gagged. Bloody crack on his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

REBEL
You can't be in here.

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL
Didn't your commander tell you who the fuck I am?

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun. Then pulls Abe off the floor.

INT. HEDGE FUND - MORNING

CLINK! Kaan taps a coffee cup to Jimmy's across their desks.

JIMMY
What time's the trade hitting?

KAAN
Whenever Peter pulls the trigger.
(rising, smile)
Tonight, we're celebrating.

He walks off. Once he's out of sight:

PETER (O.S.)
Jimmy.

Peter waves him into his office.

PETER'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy steps in and finds:

PETER
You know Michael Waller, our Chief Compliance Officer.

A suited attorney sits on the sofa. Doesn’t smile.

PETER (CONT'D)
Let’s talk Turkey.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - EVENING

Sezen heads out the back door. Into the grove, where she finds Rob on the ladder. Finishes a final graft.

ROB
Is your father happy?

SEZEN
Never.

ROB
(chuckle)
This should be the last one. And then I can get out of your hair.

SEZEN
You must be starving.

ROB
Oh, no thank you--

SEZEN
That wasn’t a question.

Rob smiles. Then tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

—-through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rebel's rifle.

WILL (O.S.)
Fucking idiot. Do you know what the market is like for Americans here?

Will ties off a suture. Leyla watches from the doorway.

WILL
Especially with your record.

ABE
Did you know?

Will keeps stitching. Ignoring the question.

ABE
Did. You. Know.

The needle stops. Will exhales. Then goes back in.

ABE
Are they al-Qaeda?

WILL
Not anymore.

Abe groans. Before he can explode--

WILL
We don't choose our friends out here. We choose our enemies.
(beat)
And a choice has finally been made. That's why they sent you.

ABE
Is it?

Will gives him a look. What?

ABE
You could have done this yourself. So what am I? Insurance?

Will blows a raspberry. No use lying.

ABE
That fucking bitch--

WILL
Don't be so hard on yourself. Most people can't survive here.

ABE
You seem okay.

WILL
I adapt to the ecosystem.

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)
It's Will by the way.

Abe meets his eyes in the mirror.

WILL
Relax, Coyote.
(smirk)
You don't need to show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch. Barks to Leyla:

WILL
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Leyla steps in, as Will answers the phone in the hallway.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

ABE
Thanks, Leyla.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call.

LEYLA
What he says?

Abe squints. What? Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA
"Shh".

ABE
Oh. He's just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe's head.

LEYLA'S ROOM

Will takes the call inside Leyla's room.

WILL
Sounds good. I'll see you soon.

As he hangs up, something catches his eye--

Her English book. Open on the desk.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere.

ROB
To home.

Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Rakı bottle. Two glasses.

They clink their glasses.

SEZEN
Where's that for you?

ROB
Pennsylvania. But these days, wherever Terrasource wants to fund my work.

SEZEN
So you trust them?

ROB
I don’t really have a choice. It’s that or let all of this die.

He looks across the grove. At the trees.

ROB (CONT'D)
You ever think about leaving?

SEZEN
I actually did a semester at UT. Hook 'em.

ROB
Seriously? Why’d you leave?

SEZEN
My mom.

Oh. She takes a long drink. He stays quiet.

SEZEN
Someone had to come back to take care of him. Of this.

ROB
They’re lucky to have you.

INT. WILL’S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Shower running steamy water.

Abe hops in. Careful to avoid his bandaged head.

His scar runs from his throat, across his chest, over his shoulder. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

LEYLA'S ROOM - SAME

Downstairs, Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

WILL (O.S.)
I'm so impressed with you.

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)
English. What a language. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like "appreciate".

LEYLA
Thanking.

WILL
Right. But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.)(CONT'D)
So when I say "I appreciate you", I could mean "I am thankful for you". Or, I could be saying...that I'm considering your worth.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)
And, Leyla - you're worth nothing to me dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA
I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL
Enough.

His eyes flash as he rises.

WILL
They’re gone. All of them.

Tears run down her cheeks.

WILL
I’m the only one who can protect you now.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL
Do you understand me?

She nods. Defeated. He touches her cheek. Then leaves.

She picks up the family photo from the floor.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob reaches for Sezen’s hand, but--

BUZZING from his pocket.

ROB
Sorry.

He checks his phone. Rises quickly. Concerned.

ROB
It’s the New York office.
(stepping away, answering)
Rob Green.
(listening)
Yes. I’m with her now.

His face drains of color.

ROB
What? What information?

He turns to Sezen. Horrified.

ROB (CONT’D)
Who’s Kaan?

Sezen goes cold.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Abe stands under the water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)
That's him.

Abe OPENS his eyes.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
The man from the border.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

ABE'S FACE in a photo from the port on Demir's laptop.

Now, he can clearly see the SCAR on his neck.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I need to see him immediately.

Demir crosses the room to a WALL OF PHOTOGRAPHS. Maps. Surveillance photos of the Reyhanlı bombing site. Plus photos of dozens of victims. Faces of the dead.

ON TOP: ABE'S FACE. With the neck scar. From drone footage.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
Do you understand me?

Demir rubs his missing finger. Excited.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I have to talk to him.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

MARCY listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.)(CONT'D)
***Before* they torture him to death.**

Fuck.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will checks ammo in his handgun. Holsters it.

Grabs his phone, makes a call. Mumbles in Arabic.

GUEST BATHROOM

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)
Get out.
(beat)
Syrian Mukhabarat are on their way.

ABE
Why do you even care? I'm only here in case something goes wrong.

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote.

GUEST BEDROOM

Someone steps in, approaches the bathroom door.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Something has gone wrong.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Silence on the other line.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Coyote?

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

A KNIFE presses into Abe's throat.

MARCY (V.O.)
Coyote, are you there?

He drops the phone.

A dot of blood forms on his skin.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Shh.

ACT IV

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Leyla holds the knife at Abe’s throat.

LEYLA
The man sells you. Tonight.

Abe studies her eyes. She’s not lying.

ABE
He’ll kill you for this.

LEYLA
Then take me.

ABE
Then he’ll kill us both.

LEYLA
I don’t care. I have no one.

Abe opens his mouth. Her brother. In Turkey. But he doesn’t say anything.

ABE
I can’t protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)
Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA
Stay.

She heads into the hall.

Abe exhales. Goes to the window. Opens it. Cool air rushes in. He looks back at the door to the hall.

INT. HEDGE FUND - KITCHEN - DAY

Kaan’s selecting some fiber snacks when his phone BUZZES in his pocket. It’s Sezen. He smiles.

KAAN
Hey. I was just thinking about you.

SEZEN (PHONE)
What the fuck did you do?

KAAN
What are you talking about?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob's rental car pulls away. Taillights disappearing down the dirt road.

SEZEN (O.S.)
Rob got fired. Because of you.

Sezen watches from the grove. Bottle of rakı in hand.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
They said he gave you insider information.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. I don’t understand.

SEZEN
You will.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan walks out of the kitchen. Finds Peter standing at his desk. Two SECURITY GUARDS behind him.

KAAN
What’s going on?

PETER
I’m making a scene. So this never happens again.
(loudly, for the floor)
Let me tell you all a little story. Kaan came to me recently with a big idea about a miracle cure for dying olive trees near his hometown. It sounded too good to be true.
(smile)
So I called the target company. And what do I learn? That his father just signed a contract with them--

KAAN
What? My father would--

PETER
(harshly cutting him off)
--to test their *very secret* new product on the family's grove. So what is it Kaan?

Kaan opens his mouth, but nothing comes out.

PETER (CONT'D)
A miraculous coincidence? Or did you try to trade on material nonpublic information?

KAAN
I--I--

PETER
I don't care. Save it for the SEC. Or the immigration court. All that matters to me is that you get the fuck out of this office.

Kaan looks around. Everyone's staring at him.

Except Jimmy. *Where is he?*

BATHROOM

Kaan checks every stall one by one. Spots feet.

KAAN
I see you.

He rips the door open. Finds the terrified Jimmy.

KAAN (CONT'D)
You ruined my fucking life.
(heaving)
What did you tell them?

JIMMY
I told them the truth--

Kaan tackles him backward against the wall.

Throws him onto the floor. Within seconds--

The security guards wrestle him out to the floor.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Abe drops out of the window to the ground. Bag on shoulders.

This is the best chance he'll get.

He heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

He spins. Low. Fast. And--

The CATTLE PROD is already in his ribs.

ZAP. Abe hits the dirt. Every muscle locked.

WILL
Careful. There's jackals out there.

Will stands over him. Prod in one hand, gun in the other. Zaps him again. Longer. Abe stops moving.

Will kicks the bag away. Checks him for weapons. Then pulls out ROPES and TAPE.

WILL
This isn't on me. I would've vastly preferred to keep you alive.

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. Knots them. Fast.

WILL
You made me choose. This is the only way I can survive. I told you.
(tying knot tight)
I feed people.

Will TAPES Abe's mouth shut.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - EVENING

Kaan is cuffed to the table when his LAWYER enters.

KAAN
I need to make a call.

LAWYER
When you're released--

KAAN
Then get me released.

LAWYER
Kaan, that kid's head is still being stitched up. The only way you're leaving today is on a flight back to Turkey.

Kaan nods. His Lawyer cocks his head. *Excuse me?*

KAAN
They're going to void my H1B anyway, aren't they?

LAWYER
It doesn't matter what they plan to do. If you leave the country, you give up everything. They'll never let you back in.

KAAN
My family needs me.

LAWYER
Kaan--

KAAN
Just get me a fucking phone.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Davut's phone sings and glows.

Finally, he rustles awake. Answers:

DAVUT
Kaan?

KAAN (PHONE)
Baba. Did you sign a contract? With an American company?
(beat)
Or was it her?

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Will sets Abe down against a tree. Runs the rope around the trunk. Cinches it.

WILL
It'll be alright, Coyote.

Tosses the cattle prod into the leaves.

Tucks his gun in his pants.

WILL (CONT'D)
Just breathe.

As he leans over to check Abe's ropes--

ZAP--

Will convulses.

Falls forward. Gun drops to the ground.

LEYLA stands behind him with the cattle prod.

Looks at Abe.

LEYLA
You owe me. Still.

From the ground, Abe sees:

The scar on Leyla's ankle.

LEYLA
Now. Hurry.

She reaches for the gun but--

Will grabs her scarred ankle.

She topples to the ground. Onto sharp fallen branches.

Abe throws his weight against the rope. The tree holds him.

In pain, Will crawls over Leyla.

WILL
I saved your life. Both of you.

Gets on top of her. Straddles her chest. Weight pressing down. She can barely breathe.

WILL (CONT'D)
And this is what I get?

He looks at Abe. Then Leyla, speaks in Arabic.

WILL
You think he's going to protect you? He's a fucking war criminal.
(beat)
It's true. They fished him out of a military prison in Mosul. Someone to burn if things go bad.

She looks at Abe. He nods. It's true.

Her hand closes around a tree branch.

WILL
He can't protect you. No one can protect you except for me.

RUSTLING in the trees.

Something's there.

Will turns to look.

LEYLA STABS his neck with a branch.

BLOOD spurts from his jugular.

And he falls forward onto Leyla.

His full weight trapping her.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - A LITTLE LATER

Drunk, Sezen stares into the grove.

Suddenly, she hears CHOPPING in the distance.

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

SEZEN
Baba?

CHOPPING getting louder as she finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Baba, stop--

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

She grabs the axe.

He doesn't let go.

DAVUT
My name. My father's name. Seven generations. You put it on a lie.

Sezen doesn't respond. He grips his chest in agony.

SEZEN
I'm saving our grove--

DAVUT
You buried us. You brought the wolves in. Foreign poison.

He RIPS the axe away from her. Some unknown strength.

DAVUT
Where is it?

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla trapped under Will's body.

Blood dripping onto her face.

She struggles to move. Or breathe.

ABE

is still tied up nearby. Mouth taped.

Pulls desperately at the ropes. Can't help.

LEYLA

tries to PUSH Will's body off. Can't. Too heavy.

The weight crushing her lungs. Then she hears:

More RUSTLING in the trees.

She stares at the dark canopy above. But can’t turn her head. Just hears--

PANTING. Getting closer.

HOT BREATH on her head.

She holds perfectly still. Eyes wide with terror.

The JACKAL's face appears above her.

Licking Will’s blood.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

ABE

watches the jackal LICK blood from Will’s neck, then from Leyla’s cheek. She cries.

He pulls harder at the ropes.

LEYLA

sees the jackal’s face inches from hers. Yellow eyes. Teeth visible. A low GROWL from its throat.

The jackal's ears perk up as--

HEADLIGHTS sweeping through the trees.

ENGINES.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Davut catches himself on a tree trunk. Breathing hard. Looks around wildly. Then he sees it.

DAVUT
There.

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK.

The axe splits through the graft joint.

Foreign wood splinters.

SEZEN
Baba. Please. Listen to me--

CRACK. Davut’s axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS sweep through the grove.

OFFICER 1
They said he'd be back here.

Their flashlights illuminate row by row...

Getting closer to:

LEYLA

The jackal still looming.

Will’s dead body still pinning her to the ground.

ABE

watches both threats. The jackal. The approaching flashlight.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

CRACK.

Davut sinks the axe into the foreign wood again.

SEZEN
(crying now)
You're going to kill it.

DAVUT
It's already dead!

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing.

They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

DAVUT
And you are not my daughter.

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back to the tree.

Raises the axe high--

Sezen grabs his ankle.

SEZEN
Baba stop!

Davut's weak body can't compensate--

His HEAD CRACKS against the tree trunk.

A sickening sound.

He hangs against the trunk. Then slides down it.

Crumples at the foot of the tree.

Blood pours from the front of his head...

...down the bark.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

The Officers sweep their flashlight over:

LEYLA'S FACE. Blood-streaked. Trapped. Terrified.

OFFICER 1
What the--

THE JACKAL

launches from the darkness.

BITES an Officer's forearm.

LEYLA

hears the officer SCREAM.

SNARLING. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 1 (O.S.)
Run!

ABE

sees the Officers racing to their truck.

But Leyla remains under Will. Lungs compressed.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen's on her back in the dirt. Where he shoved her.

SEZEN
Baba?

Nothing. Davut's shape at the foot of the tree. Still.

She rolls to get up. Her right arm doesn't come with her.

She screams into her teeth. Looks down. The shoulder sits wrong. Out of its socket.

She tries again. Left arm only. Gets a knee under her. The ground tilts and she goes down on her face. Dirt in her teeth. His blood on the ground, inches away.

No one is coming.

She stops. Lays her cheek on the ground. And closes her eyes.

INTERCUT:

- LEYLA opens her mouth. No air enters.

- The TREE above Sezen RUSTLES. Her eyes open.

- LEYLA works a hand free. Claws at Will's shirt.

- SEZEN digs her elbow in. Drags herself a foot closer.

- LEYLA wedges her knee under his hip.

- SEZEN reaches for Davut’s sleeve. Falls short.

- LEYLA rocks Will’s body. Once. Twice. Teeth bared.

- SEZEN lunges forward. Finally grabs Davut’s shirt.

- LEYLA DUMPS Will onto the ground beside her.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen rolls Davut onto his back.

She bends over him. Breathes into his mouth.

Pumps his chest with her working arm.

One. Two. Three.

SEZEN
Come on. Come on.

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN
Baba. Please.

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN
Baba.

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Blood pooling into Syrian earth from Will's neck.

Leyla on her back beside him. Staring at the sky. Catching her breath.

After a moment, she rises. Finds her way to Abe.

RIPS the tape off his mouth. Ouch.

ABE
(gasping for breath)
Thank you.

She unties him.

As Abe rises, he hears:

PANTING from the trees.

ABE
Leyla.

The jackal emerges from the trees. Limping. Covered in blood.

Leyla backs away, scared.

But Abe approaches. He sees:

A <u>bullet wound</u> in its side.

Eye contact. A moment of peace.

He reaches carefully--

The jackal BITES his wrist.

Then limps off into the trees.

Blood drips from Abe's arm...

...into the dirt.

INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - NIGHT

Demir talks to a CONTACT as he drives through the night.

DEMIR
I said I need him alive.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it.

Drives faster.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - NIGHT

Marcy monitors Demir's call.

CONTACT (PHONE)
That's up to God now.

She tosses the headset.

Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY
He's gone.

VOICE (PHONE)
And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)
You knew the risk. He's not ours.
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY
I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Zips her bag.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla waits alone. Just her map and photos.

Abe finally returns, with his backpack and another duffel full of supplies (looted from Will's compound).

LEYLA
Where now?

ABE
Your brother.

Leyla shakes her head gravely.

ABE
He’s alive.

She stops. Can't speak.

ABE
I swear. Will told me. He’s somewhere in Turkey. I’ll take you. If you know where he was going.

Leyla looks at him for a moment. *Can she trust a war criminal? Does she even have a choice?*

Slowly, she pulls out the map. Fumbles to open it. Shows him.

LEYLA
Hatay.

ABE
Then we better get over the border before daybreak.

He starts walking toward the dark mountains.

Before she follows, she looks at the family photo.

LEYLA
I’m coming...

Touches her brother’s face.

MATCH CUT TO:

MUSA

hides behind a tree.

LEYLA (V.O.)(CONT’D)
...Musa.

Terrified. But the fight is over.

Sezen is just sitting there. Davut’s body in her arms.

She looks up. Eye contact. *What did he see?*

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Then realizes: it's Davut's phone.

INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT

Kaan waits in line for the Turkish Airlines desk.

Calling Davut. Finally, the call is answered.

KAAN
Baba. I'm on my way home.

No response.

But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove. It settles him.

KAAN
We can fix this.

SEZEN (PHONE)
No. We can't.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Sezen hangs up Davut's phone.

Then holds him tight in her lap.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response...

...and for the first time this year...

...the branches seem to grow.

HOWLING in the distance--

CUT TO BLACK.